

# TRADING TEXTILE IN BAHRAIN



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**DAB-24**



# Who Are We?

Our role is to analyze Bahrain's textiles trade data, market demand, sourcing costs, tariffs, and regional trade flows to identify the most viable, scalable, and profitable investment opportunity.



# Agenda

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**Introduction**



**Scenario**



**Objectives**



**Analysis**



**Recommendations**



**Limitations**



# Introduction

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The **textile and fabric industry** plays a major role in **manufacturing and trading worldwide**. This is due to the process involved in **converting raw fibers to finished products** being divided **geographically**.

**Bahrain's** strategic location and strong regional trade connections gives them the role of trading and distributing these products which creates opportunities for businesses to serve both the **local** market and wider **GCC** region.

There are **multiple types** of fabrics & textiles that are distributed throughout **several industries**, with **clothing** being commonly traded in Bahrain.





# Scenario

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**Fakhro Textiles & Garments** is a mid-sized entrepreneurial company exploring opportunities in **Bahrain's consumer trading sector**, excluding commodities such as oil and aluminum.

With existing experience in **fabrics and finished garments through regional traders**, the company is aiming to source directly from **manufacturing countries**, and also looking into opportunities to **re-export** excess inventory **regionally**.



# Objectives

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- Which **countries supply most** of Bahrain's textiles, and at **what price per KG**?
- Which **textile categories dominate imports** (Garments vs. Raw materials)?
- How have textile imports and re-exports **changed over the past 5 years**?
- What are the **top destinations** for Bahrain's textile re-exports?
- Is it better to sell **locally** in Bahrain or re-export to **other countries**?



# Analysis

# Bahrain Trade Overview

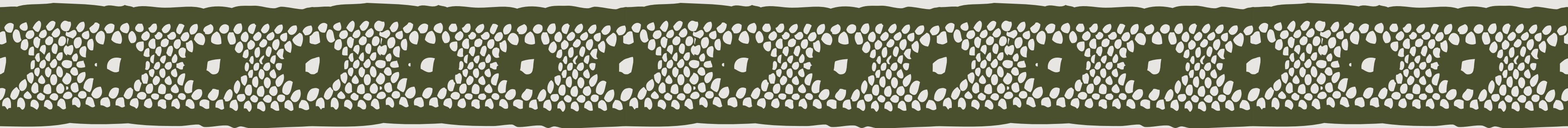


# Bahrain Total Imports

Number of Transactions: 1.60M

Total Value (BD): 28.99B

Total Weight (KG): 133.61B



# Bahrain Total Re - Exports

Number of Transactions: 244.54K

Total Value (BD): 4.46B

Total Weight (KG): 2.23B

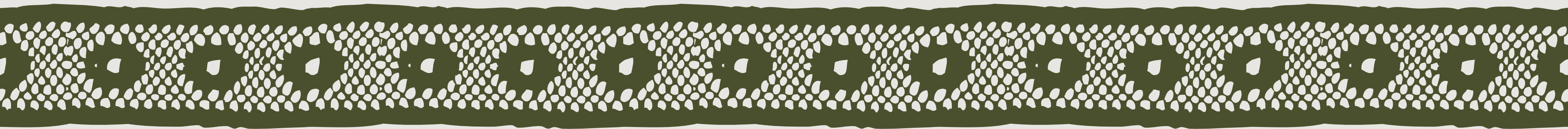
# Bahrain Textile Imports

# Bahrain's Imported Textiles

Number of Transactions: 220.09K

Total Value (BD): 751.89M

Total Weight (KG): 241.94M



# Percentage of Textile & Fabric out of Consumer Imports

Machinery / Electrical

19.48%

Textiles

13.73%

Miscellaneous

10.11%

Foodstuffs

8.97%

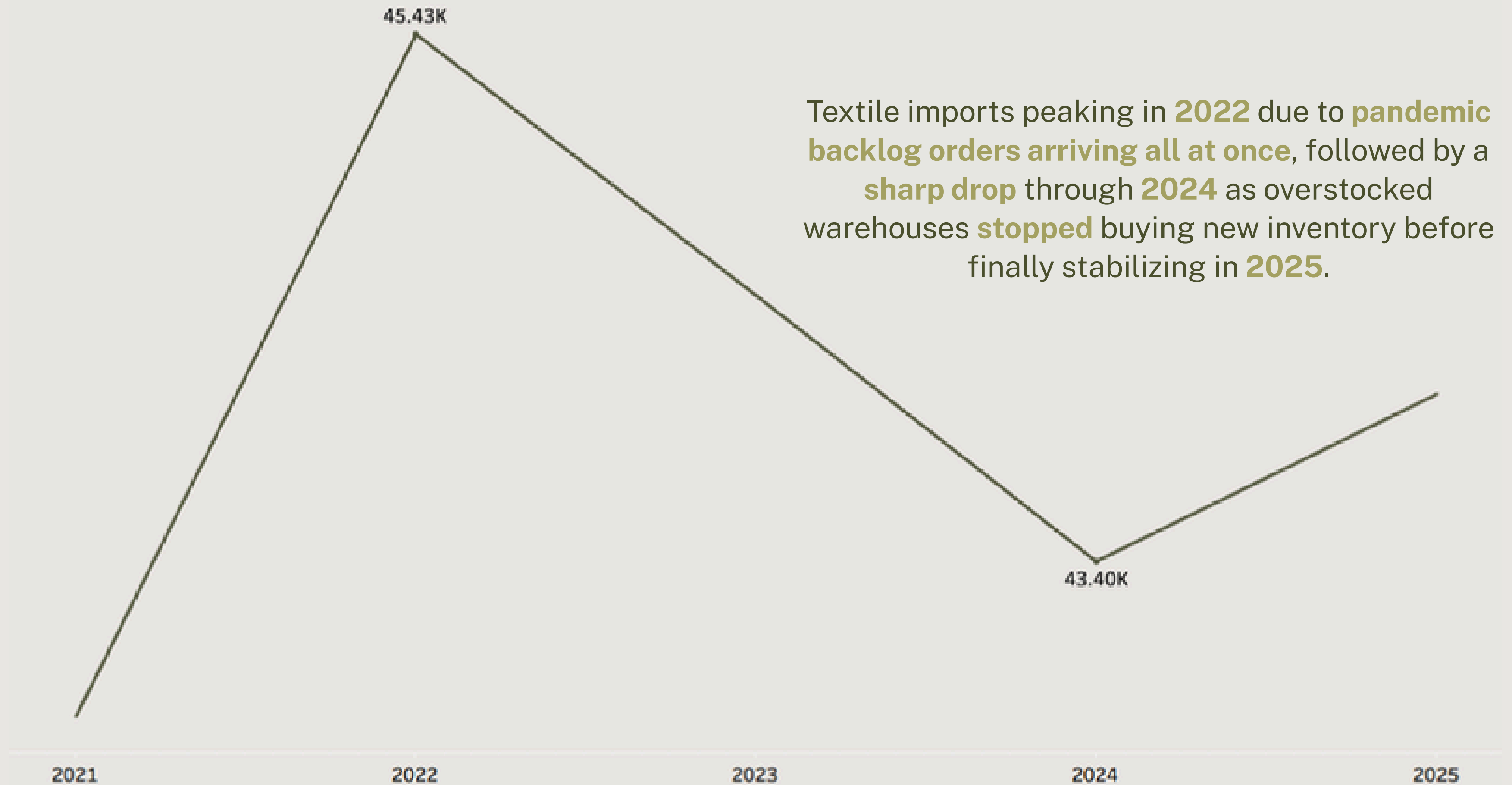
Plastics / Rubbers

6.50%

Textiles represent **13.73%** of **consumer imports**, ranking as the **second-largest category** after Machinery/Electrical indicating **strong local market demand** and supporting textiles as a **significant investment opportunity in Bahrain**

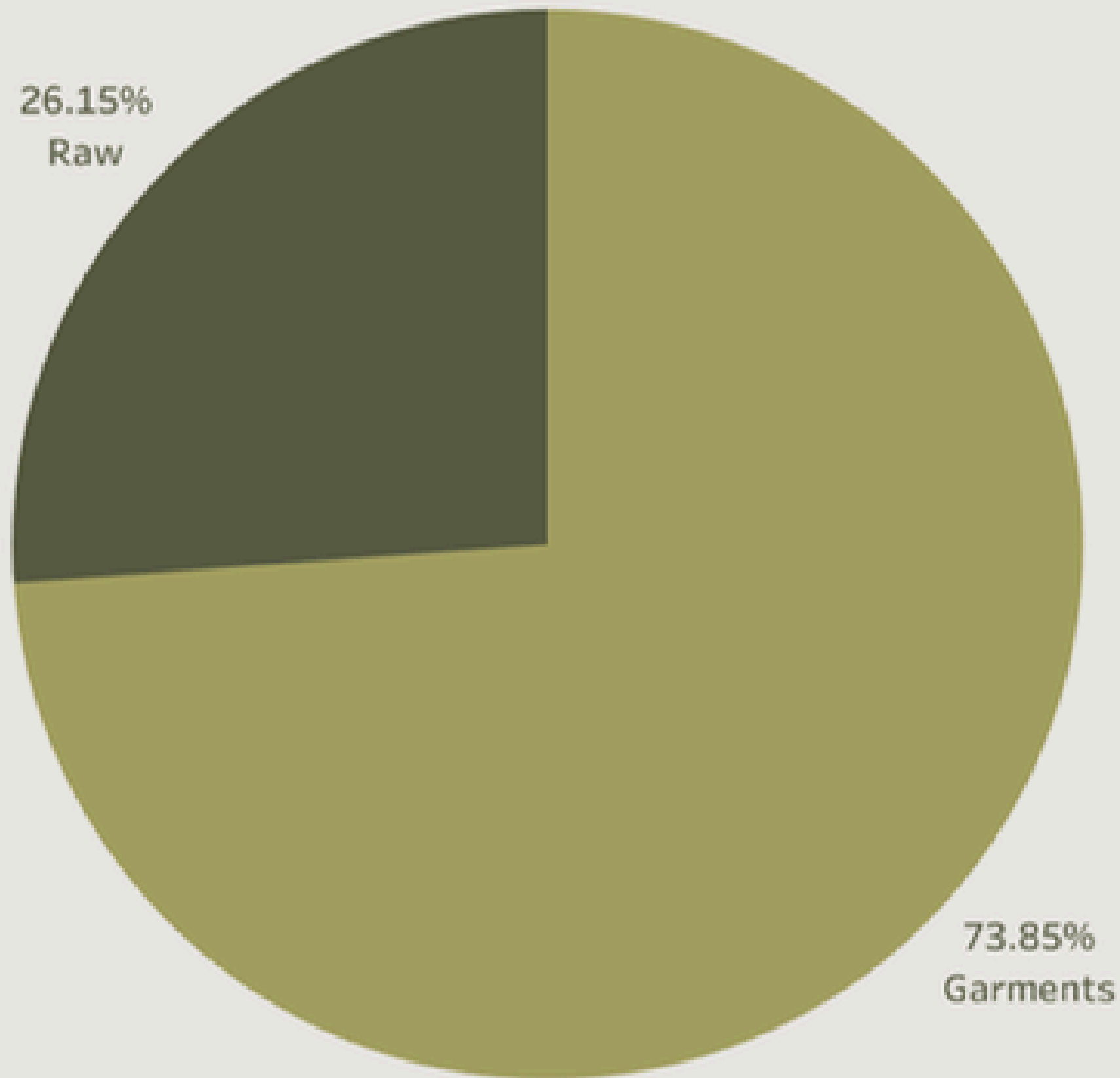


## 5 Years of Textile Imports



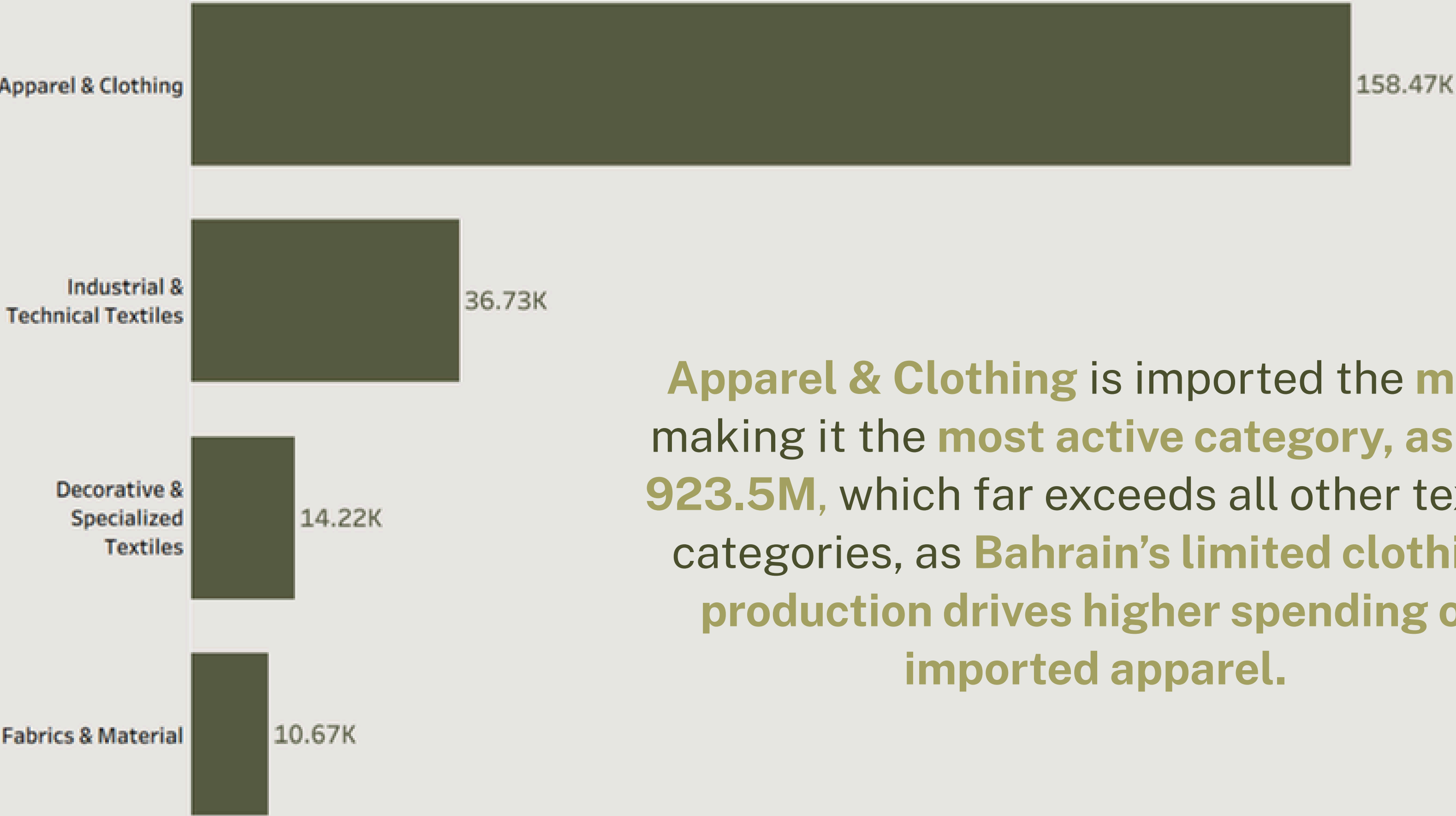
# (A) Types of Textile Imported

# Raw VS Garments Imports



Garments make up the **vast majority of imports**, showing a strong local market preference for **ready-to-sell products** over raw materials, due to limited local production and strong retail demand.

# Bahrain Frequently Imported Textiles



**Apparel & Clothing** is imported the **most**, making it the **most active category**, as it is **923.5M**, which far exceeds all other textile categories, as **Bahrain's limited clothing production drives higher spending on imported apparel.**

# Bahrain Apparel & Clothing Imports per Import Frequency



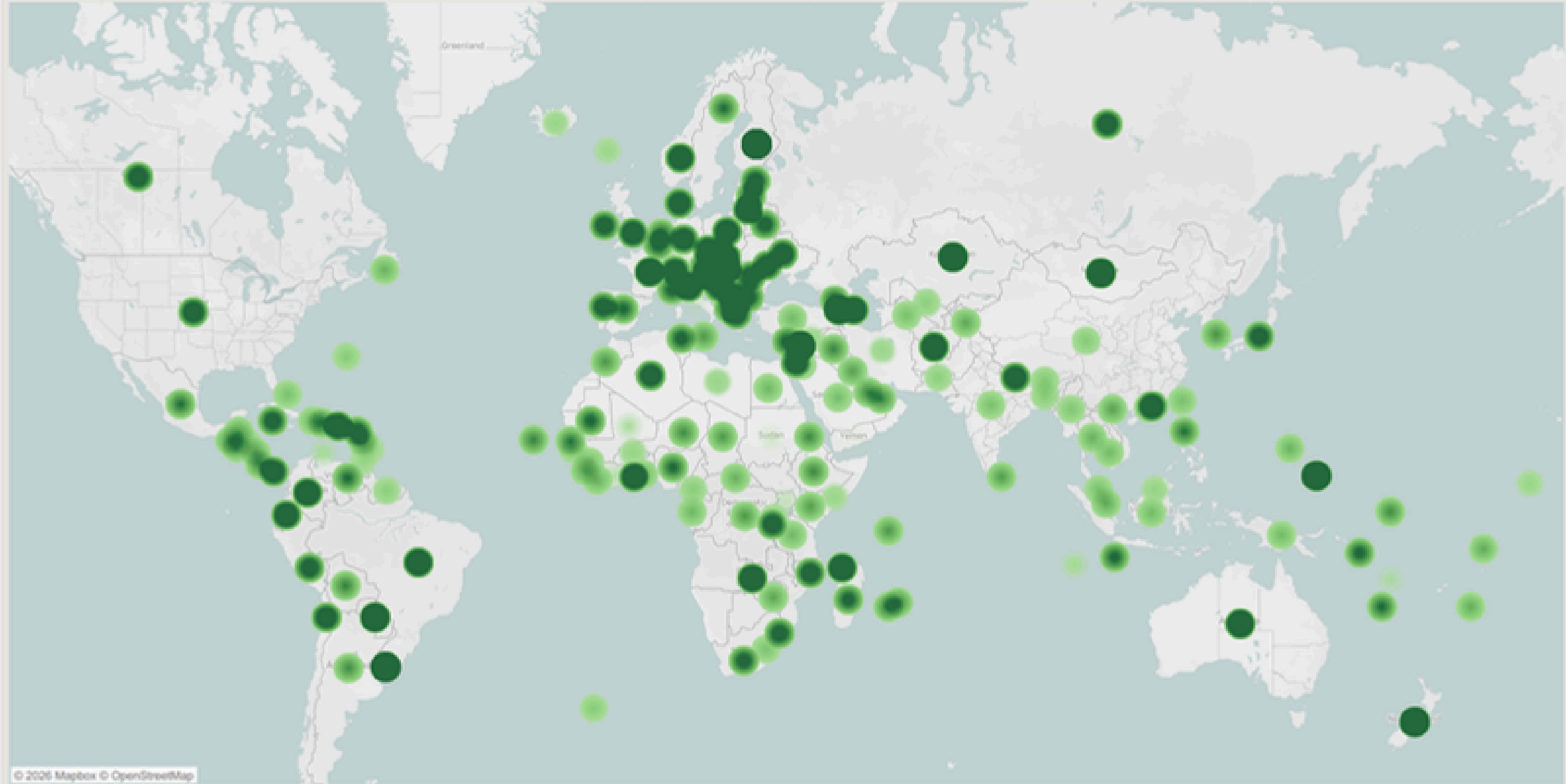
**Non-knitted and knitted apparel** have almost the **same high frequency** , showing they are **equally** popular and in **high** demand.



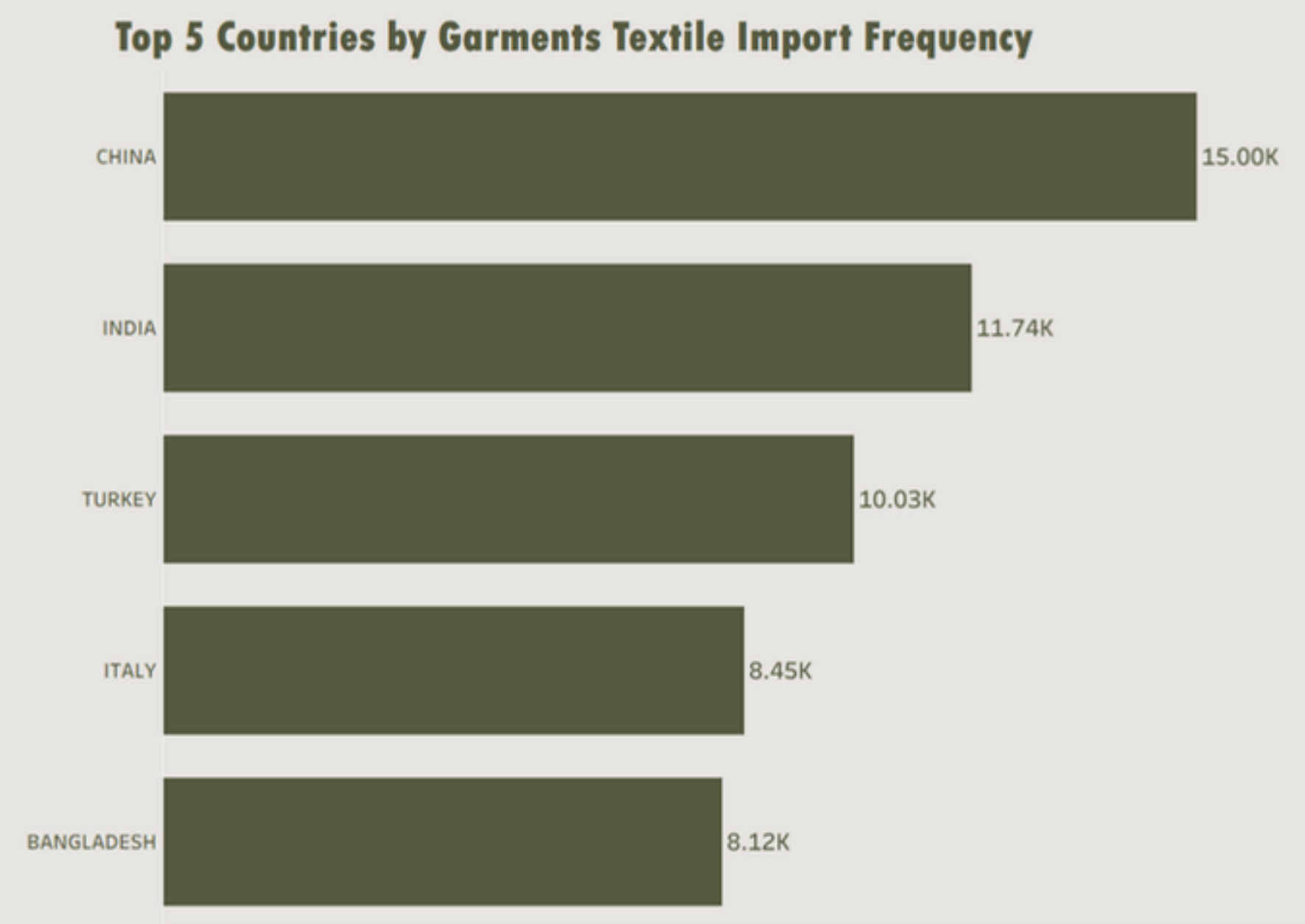
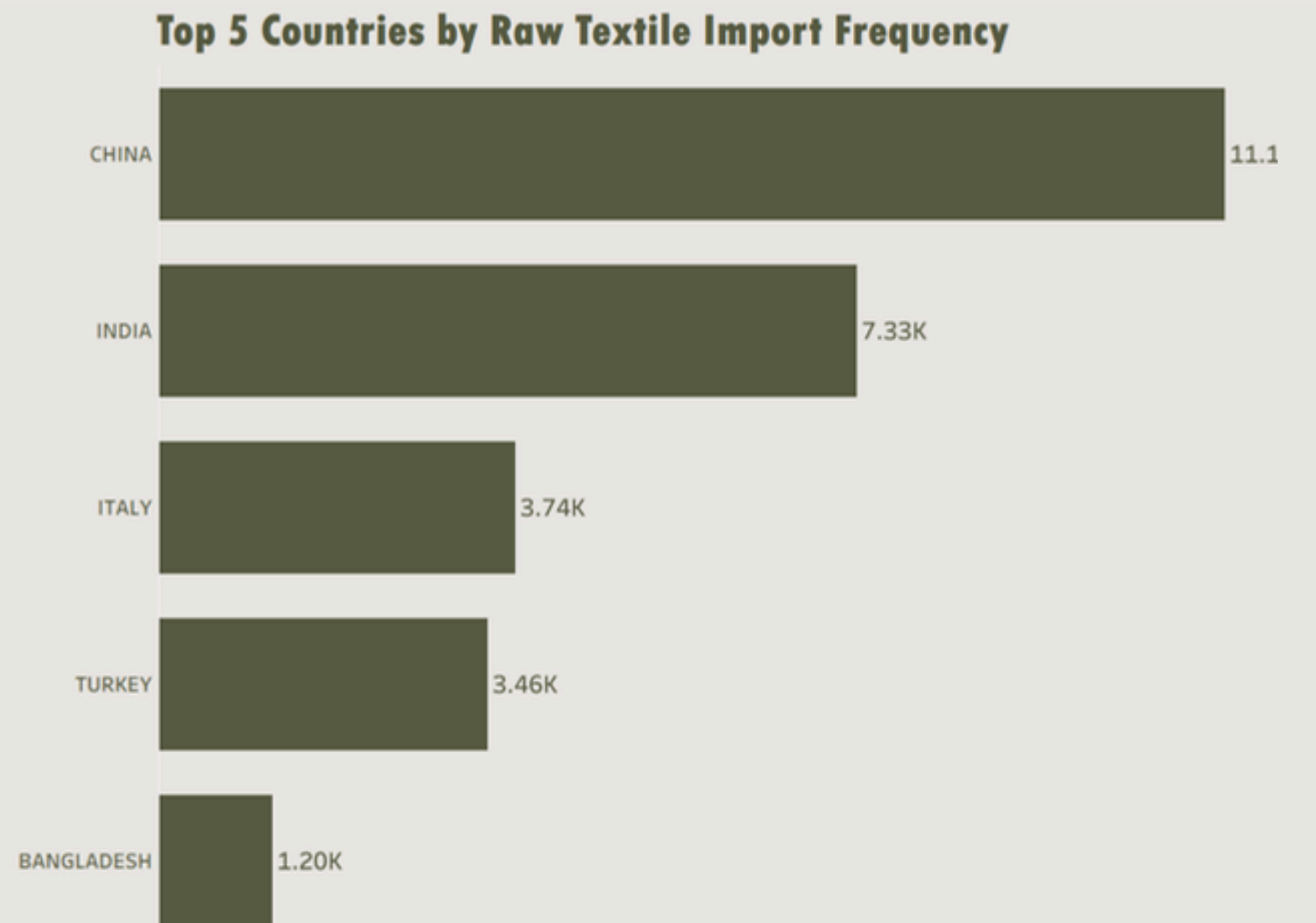
## (B) Textile Sourcing Countries & Prices

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## Imports & Import Prices

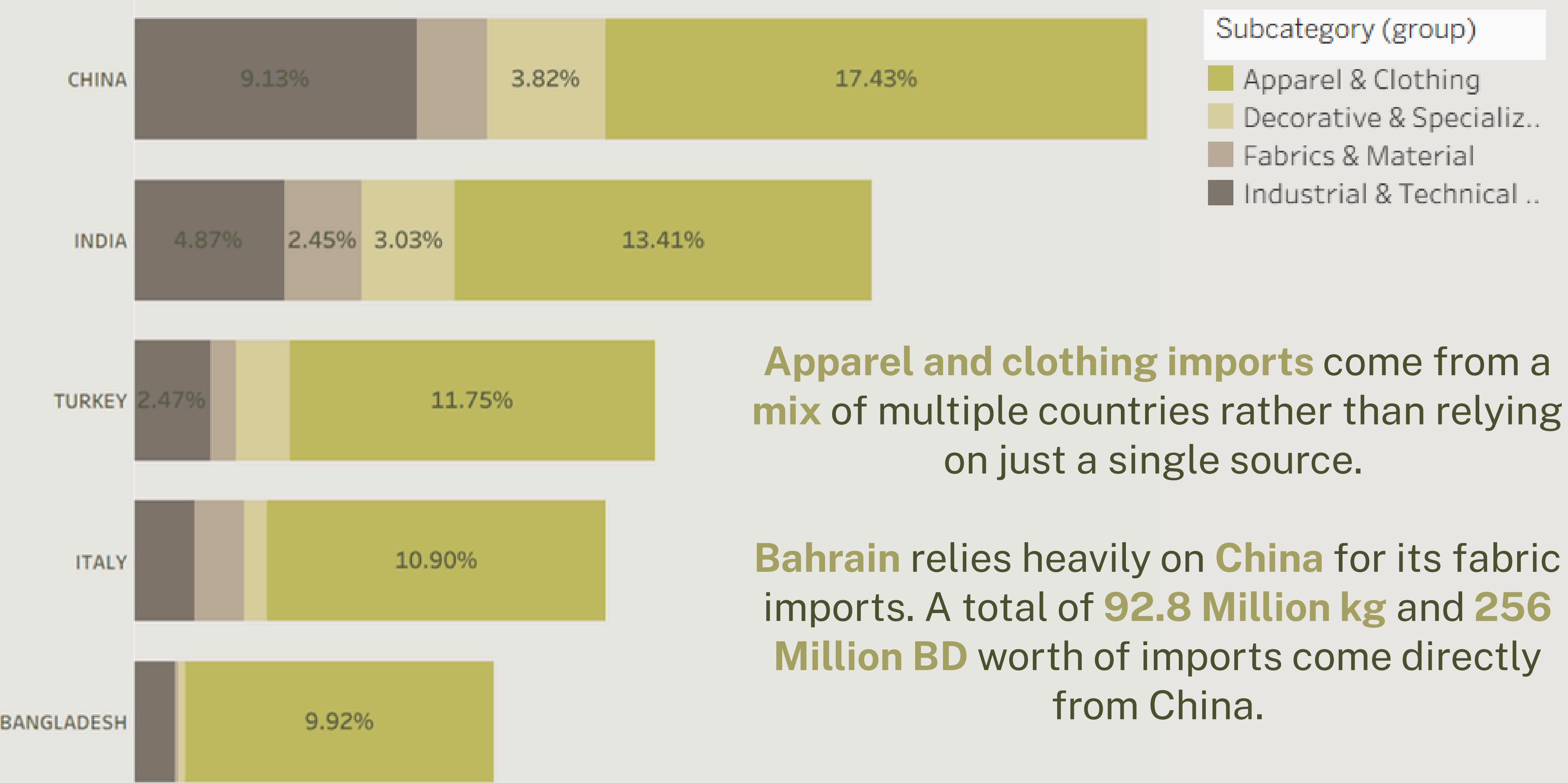


Bahrain **imports** textiles from **many different countries** around the world, and **prices vary** based on factors like **shipping, quality, and supplier location**.



**China** is **Bahrain's** leading supplier of both **raw textiles** and **garments**, because of its **competitive prices**, **wide product range**, and **strong export capacity** make it a preferred source.

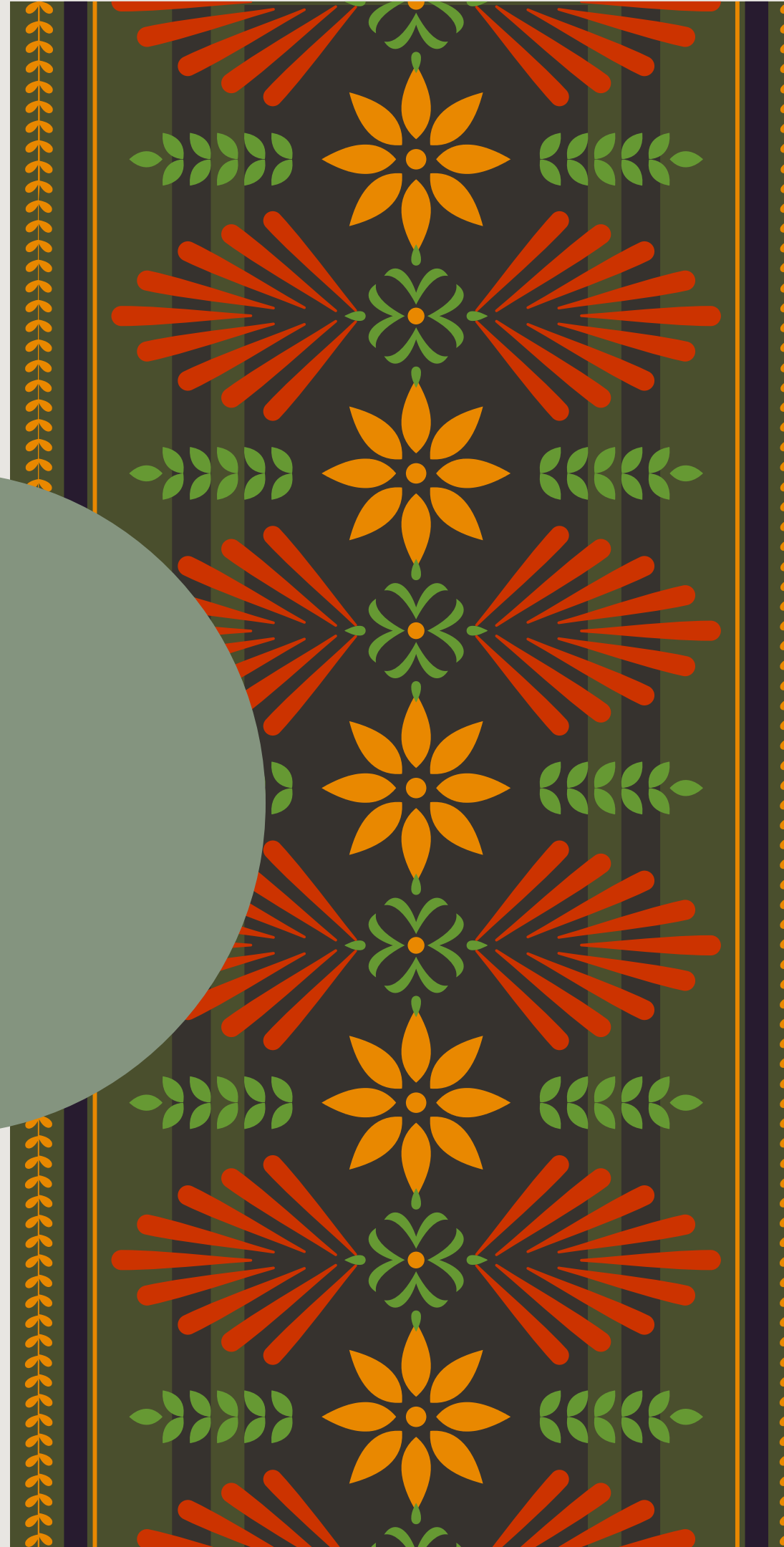
# Top 5 countries by frequency of textile imports to Bahrain



Apparel and clothing imports come from a mix of multiple countries rather than relying on just a single source.

Bahrain relies heavily on China for its fabric imports. A total of 92.8 Million kg and 256 Million BD worth of imports come directly from China.

$$\text{Price per (KG)} = \frac{\text{Total Value(BD)}}{\text{Weight(KG)}}$$

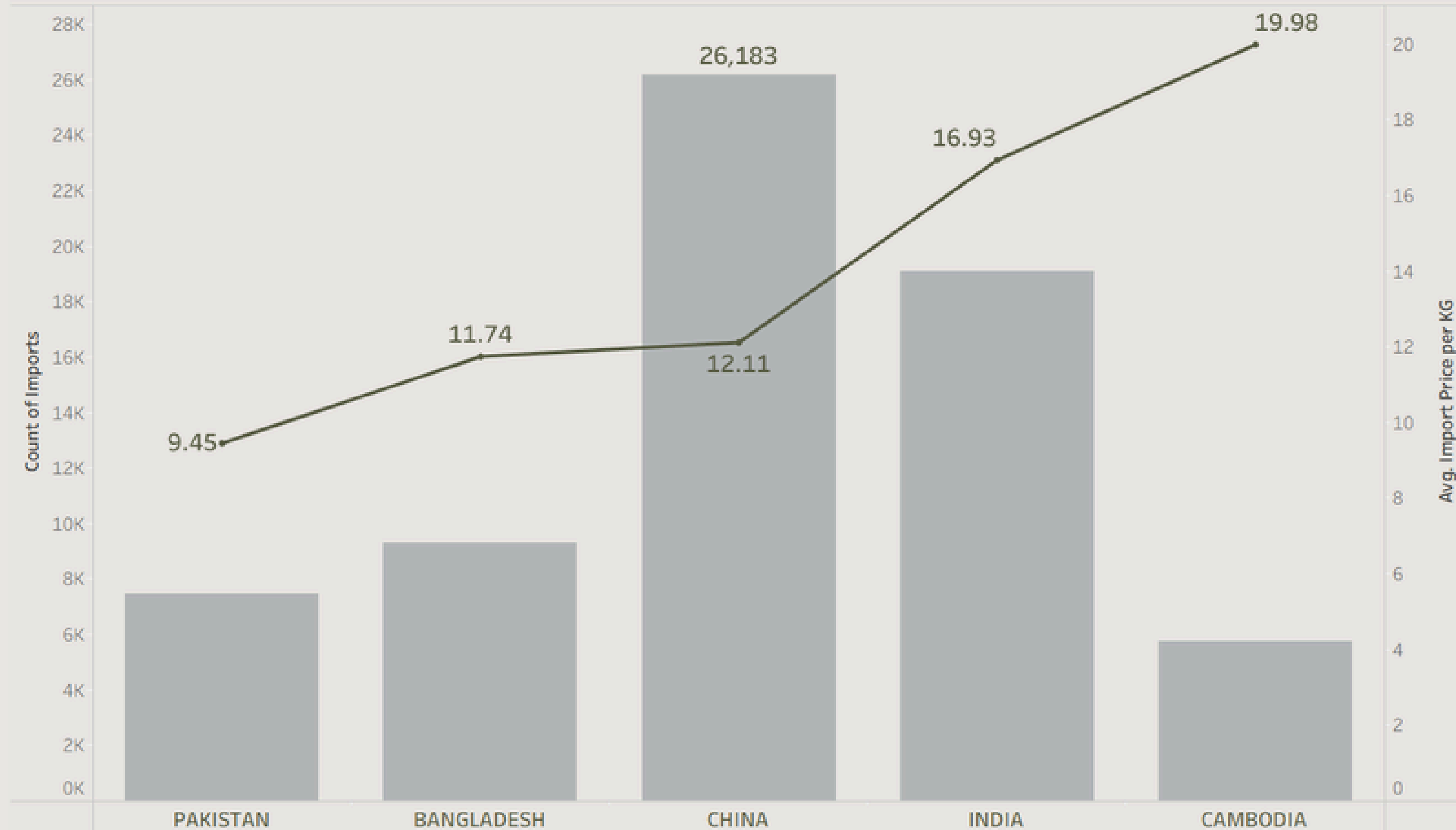




# Average Price per KG (BD) for Apparel & clothing in countries



## Countries Supplying Textiles to Bahrain and Their Price per KG



**Bahrain** depends heavily on **China**, China is **not** the **cheapest** option. We should **consider** more cost-effective **alternatives** like **Pakistan** and **Bangladesh**.



# (C) Monthly Import Prices

## Import Prices in PAKISTAN



Import prices **fluctuated** throughout the year, peaking in **November**. This may be because of retailers stock up for **Bahrain's winter** season and **year-end** shopping, **increasing** demand for **higher-value** textiles in **November**.

# Bahrain Textile Re-exports

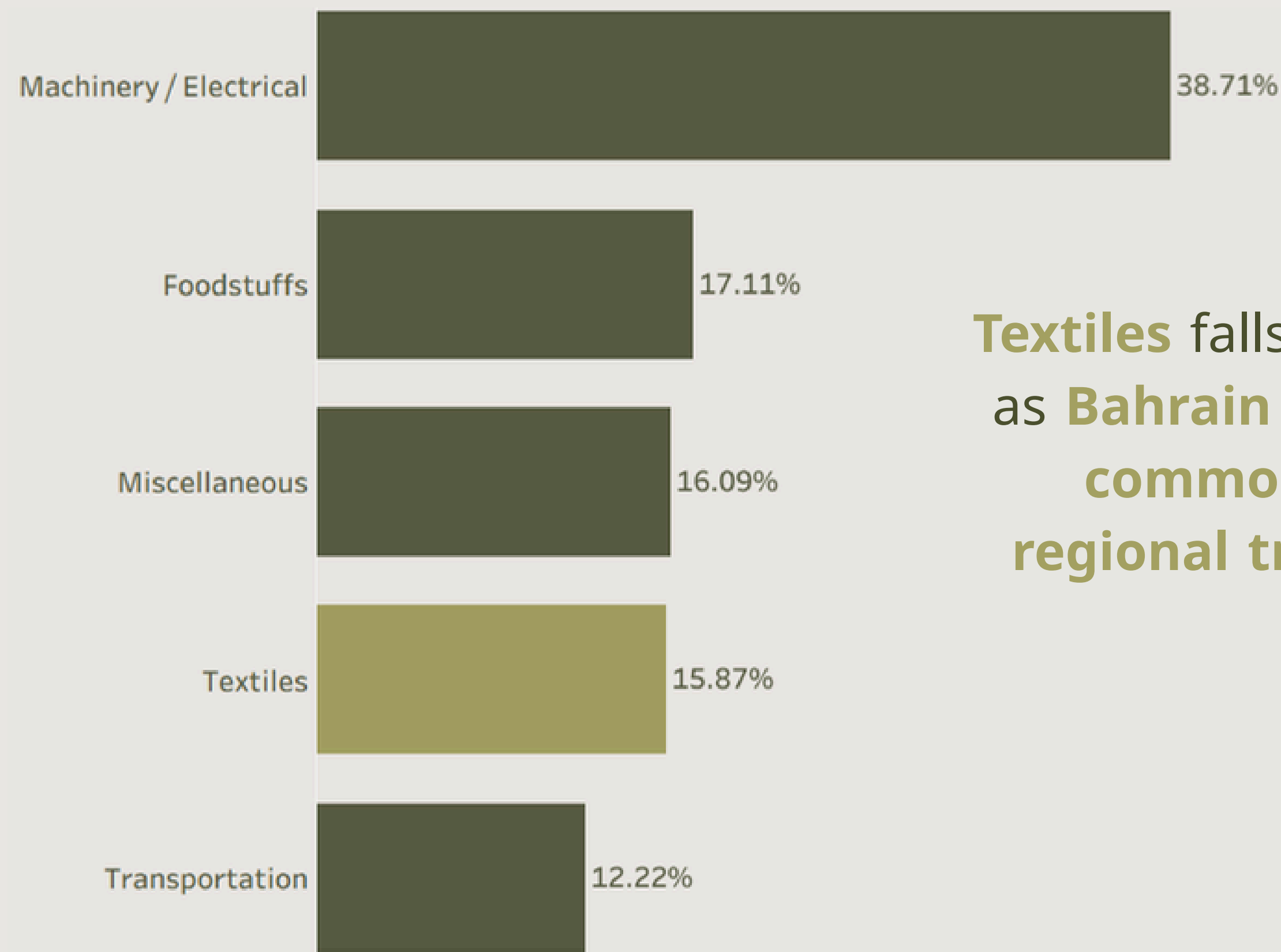
## **Bahrain's Re - Exported Textiles**

Number of Transactions: 22.67K

Total Value (BD): 110.91M

Total Weight (KG): 13.39M

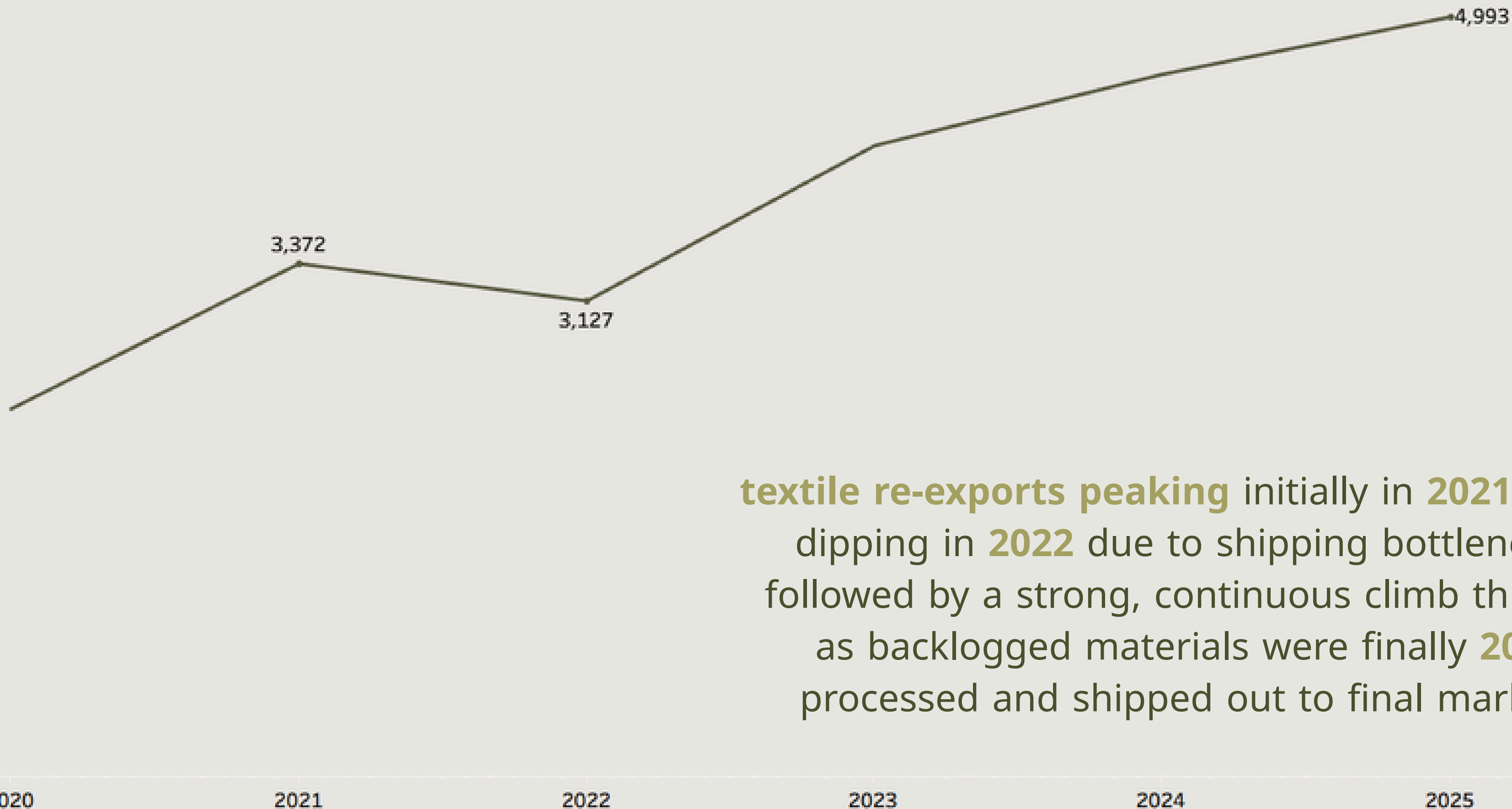
# Percentage of Textile & Fabric out of Consumer Re-Exports



**Textiles** falls the **4<sup>th</sup>** in re-exports frequency as **Bahrain focuses heavily on industrial commodities.** Yet, it still **acts as a regional transit hub** for **consumer soft goods.**



## 5 year of Textile Re - Exports

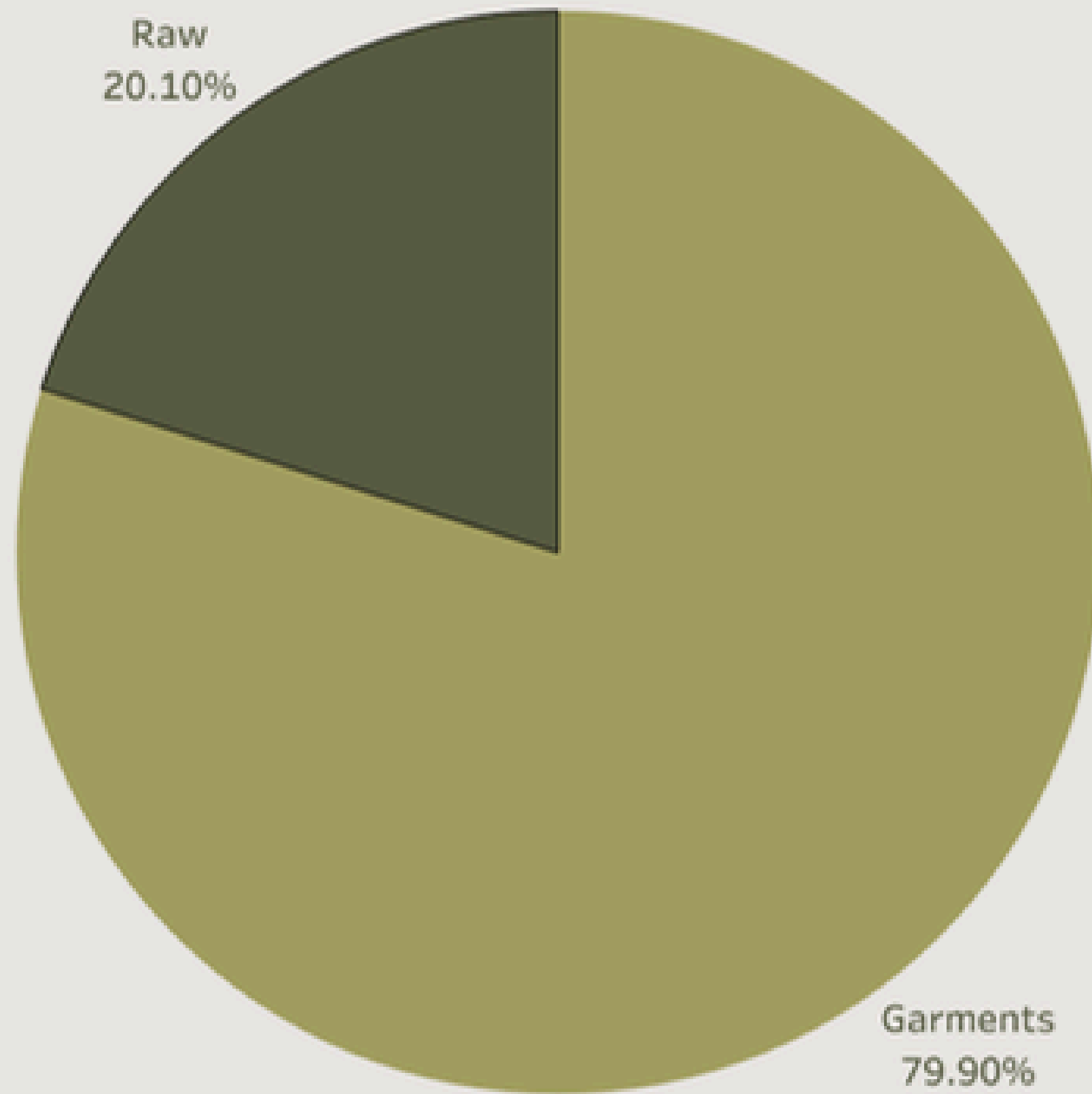


**textile re-exports peaking** initially in **2021** before dipping in **2022** due to shipping bottlenecks followed by a strong, continuous climb through as backlogged materials were finally **2025** processed and shipped out to final markets

# (A) Types of Textile Re-Exported



# Raw VS Garments Re-exports



**Garments** dominate **Bahrain's** textile **re-exports** due to strong -regional demand for ready-to sell clothing

# Top 5 Fabric & Textile Sub-categories per Re-export Frequency

Apparel & Clothing

17.65K

Industrial & Technical Textiles

3.91K

Decorative & Specialized Textiles

0.83K

Fabrics & Material

0.28K

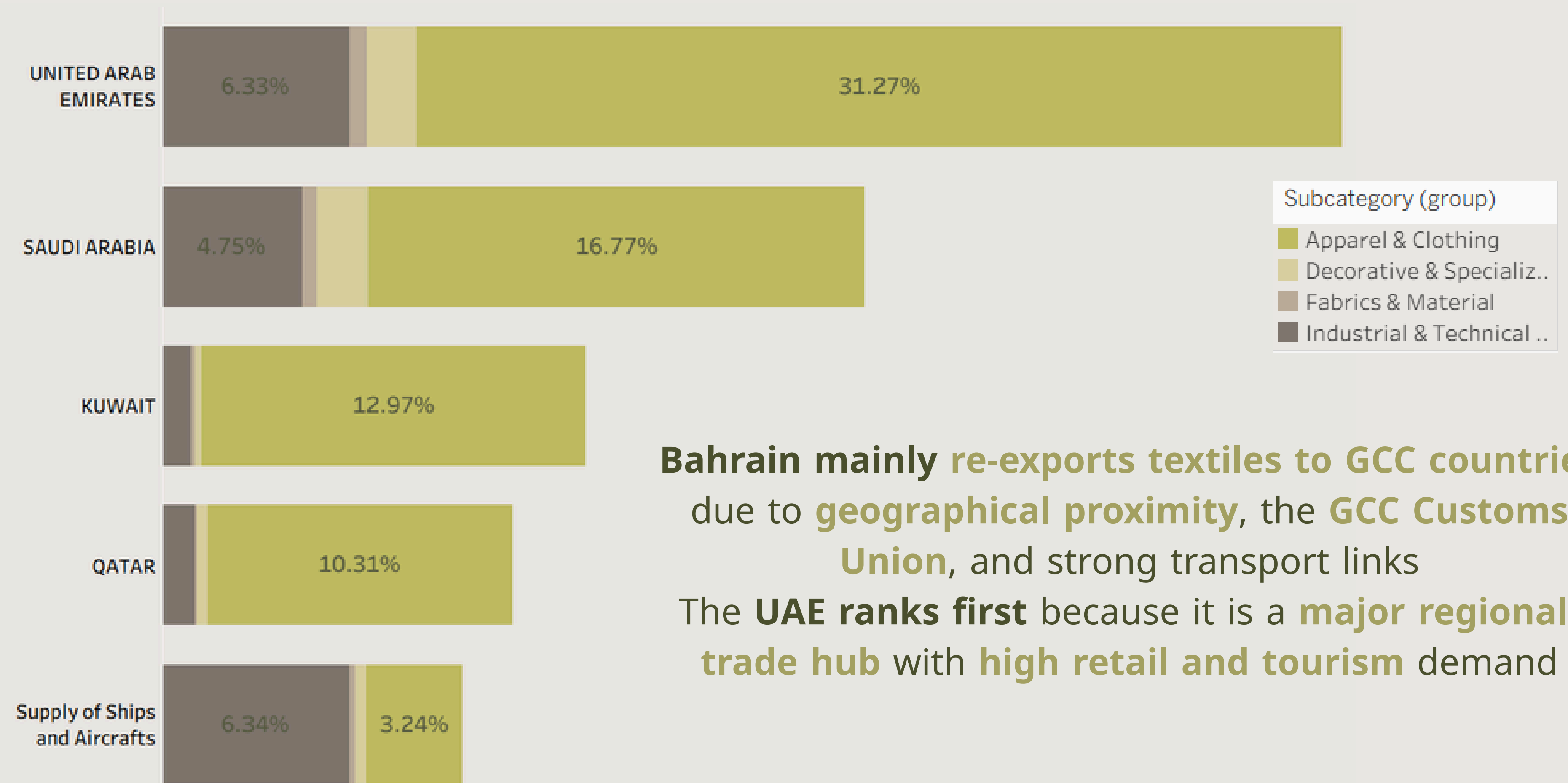
**Apparel leads** textile **re-exports** because ready made clothing has stronger regional demand

# Apparel & Clothing Re-exports per Re-export Frequency



# (B) Destinations & Prices

# Top 5 Textile Re-Export Destinations



**Bahrain mainly re-exports textiles to GCC countries** due to **geographical proximity**, the **GCC Customs Union**, and strong transport links. The **UAE ranks first** because it is a **major regional trade hub** with **high retail and tourism** demand.



Re-Export Destinations Price per KG (BD)



The UAE has the highest re-export price per kg, due to demand for higher-value textiles and premium products

# Dashboard

Bahrain Imports

Textile Importing Frequency

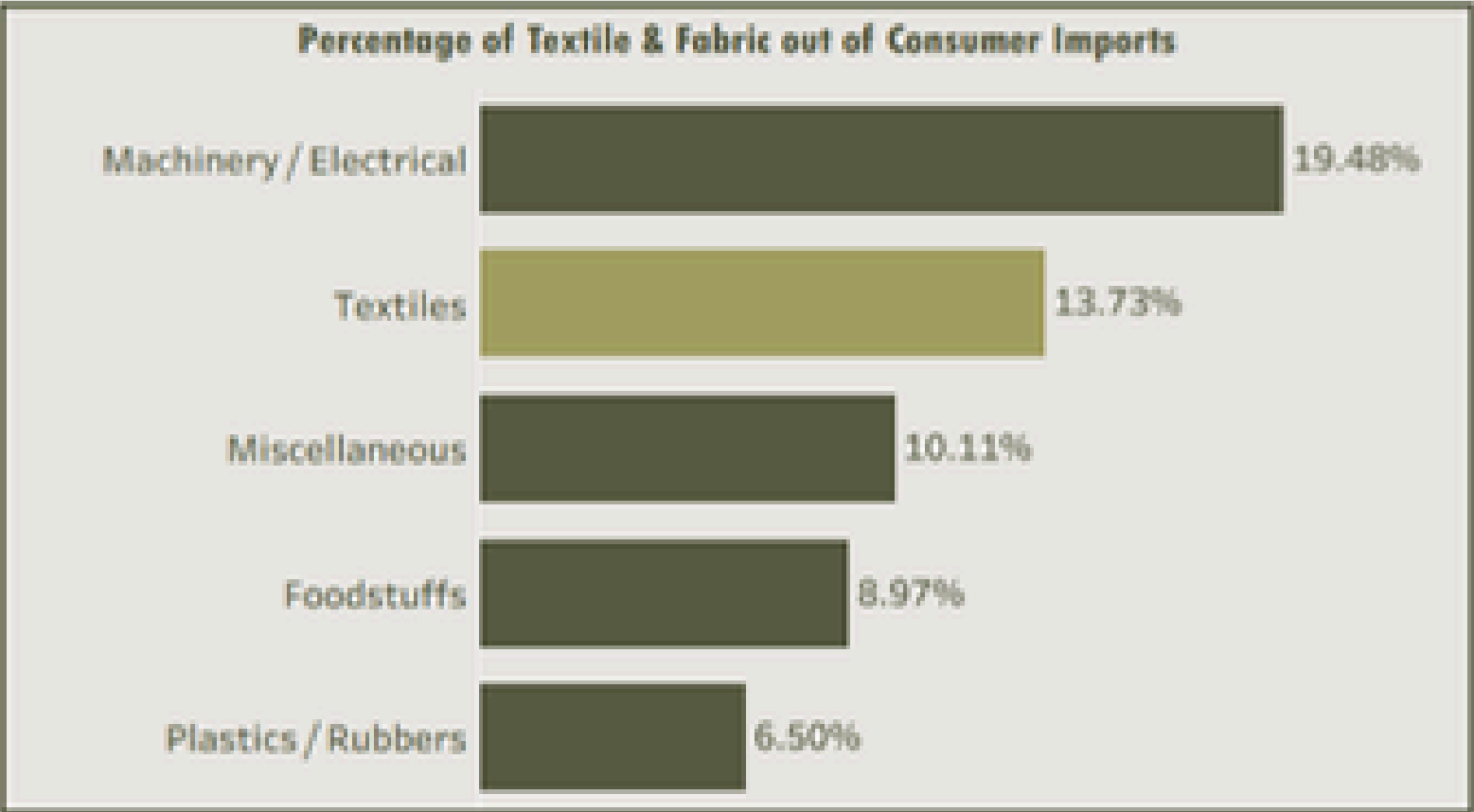
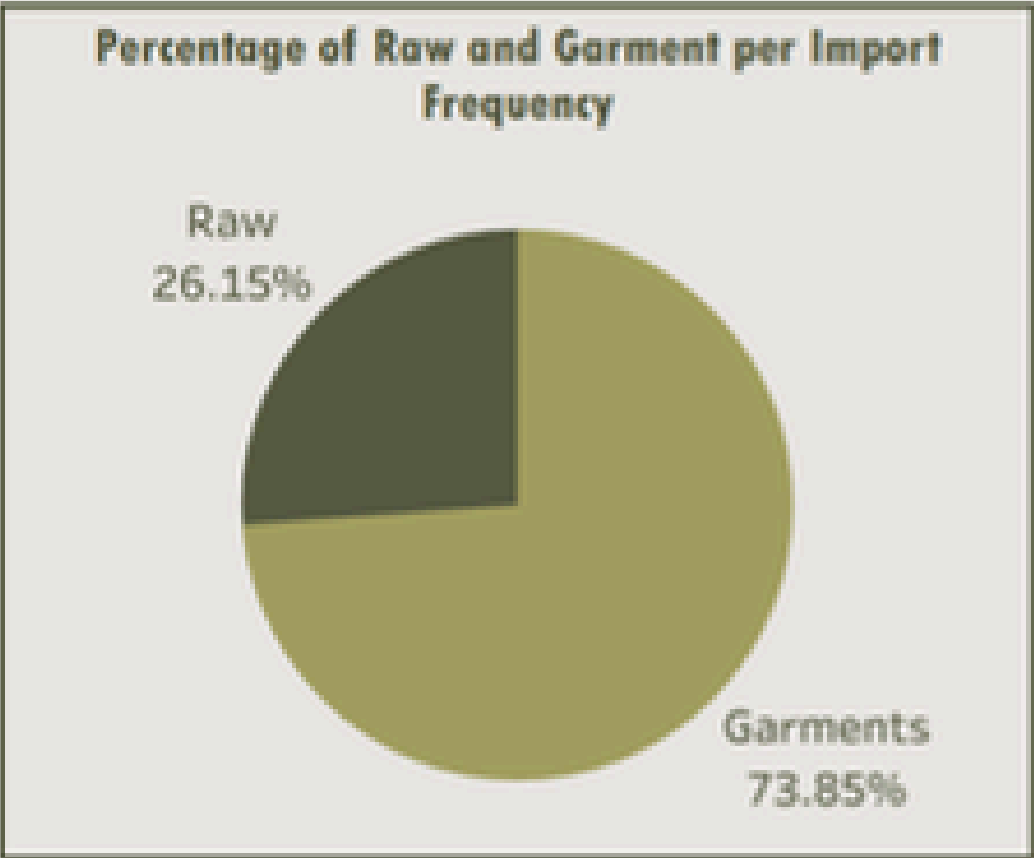
220.09K

Bahrain's Imported Textiles Total Value (BD)

751.89M

Bahrain's Imported Textiles Total Weight (KG)

241.94M



- Subcategory
- Industrial & Consumer
  - Fabrics & Materials
  - Decorative
  - Apparel & Clothing

Import Measure

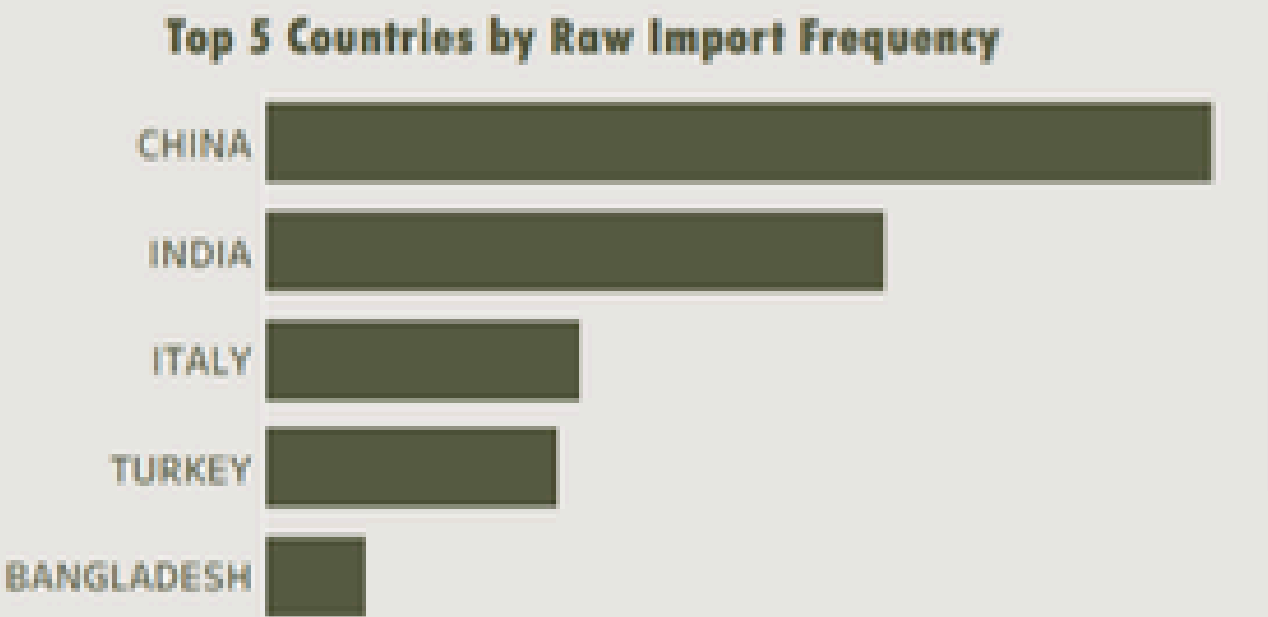
Import Frequency

Country Name

PAKISTAN

Raw/Garments

Raw





# Recommendations

- ✔ **Pakistan is the world's 3rd largest textile exporter, yet it is still a minor supplier for Bahrain despite its high-quality apparel and competitive pricing.**
- ✔ **The Pakistan-GCC Free Trade Agreement (FTA) is in its final stages. Textiles and garments are officially designated for 0% zero-tariff status under the final framework .**
- ✘ **Existing re-exports primarily serve GCC restocking needs.**
- ✘ **Double shipping costs and the Rules of Origin trap (The tariff is 0% on paper, but hidden supply chain rules make it nearly impossible for many products to actually qualify).**

# Limitations

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## **Lack of Profitability Data:**

The data **does not** include **operational costs or margins**, which prevents us from calculating exact profit figures.

## **Lack of Re-export Data and Reasons:**

We do not have data regarding related imported transaction and the specific reasons behind them.

## **Lack of Shipment Data:**

We lack data on shipping methods, duration, and costs, preventing us from analyzing logistical choices

